BEREND BOTJE

Senior Java Developer / Software Architect

Location: Rijswijk, Netherlands

Born: March 30, 1975 (Utrecht)

Experience: 26+ Years in IT

PROFILE

A highly experienced software professional with a career spanning from the Y2K COBOL era to modern Cloud-Native Java architectures. Transitioned to Java in 2005 and has since delivered high-impact solutions across financial, public, and logistics sectors. Expert in legacy migrations, microservices, and leading Agile teams within "detachering" environments.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- **BSc Computer Science** – Utrecht University (1998)
- **Oracle Certified Professional:** Java SE 7, 8, 11, and 17 Developer
- **Microsoft Certified:** Azure Solutions Architect Expert (AZ-305)
- **Microsoft Certified:** Azure Developer Associate (AZ-204)
- **Scrum.org:** Professional Scrum Master I (PSM I)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Employer: Qualogy (2018 – Jan 2026)

Project 10: Green Energy Transition Platform (Energy Sector)

- **Situation:** A utility provider needed to scale their smart-grid monitoring to handle millions of IoT events.
- **Task:** Migrate a monolithic Spring Boot app to a reactive, event-driven architecture on Azure.
- **Action:** Led development using Java 17 and Spring Cloud. Implemented Azure Functions for serverless processing and utilized Kafka for event streaming.
- **Result:** System throughput increased by 400%, and operational costs dropped by 30%.

- **Keywords:** Java 17, Spring Boot, Azure Functions, Kubernetes (AKS), Kafka, Terraform.

Project 9: Digital Customs Initiative (Public Sector)

- **Situation:** Dutch Customs required a high-security portal for post-Brexit trade declarations.
- **Task:** Build a robust, scalable API gateway to process international shipping data.
- **Action:** Developed microservices using Spring Boot 2.x and Java 11. Integrated Azure Active Directory for OIDC-based security.
- **Result:** Delivered a production-ready system in 8 months, handling 1M+ daily declarations.
- **Keywords:** Java 11, Spring Security, Azure DevOps, Docker, PostgreSQL, REST.

Project 8: Legacy Modernization (Financial Services)

- **Situation:** A large bank was running its core risk engine on Java 6 and WebLogic.
- **Task:** Upgrade the tech stack to Java 11 and migrate to a containerized environment.
- **Action:** Conducted a deep-dive audit and refactored deprecated EJB logic into Spring Beans; containerized the workload with Docker.
- **Result:** Improved deployment frequency from monthly to weekly cycles.
- **Keywords:** Java 11, Spring Core, Docker, WebLogic to Tomcat migration, JUnit 5.

Employer: Sogeti (2010 – 2018)

Project 7: Logistics Real-time Tracking (Transportation)

- **Situation:** An international courier needed real-time visibility into their fleet.
- **Task:** Develop a backend to aggregate GPS data and provide a RESTful API.
- **Action:** Used Java 8 (lambdas/streams) to process data streams and implemented MongoDB for fast writes.
- **Result:** Reduced data latency from 5 minutes to under 10 seconds.
- **Keywords:** Java 8, Spring Boot, MongoDB, Maven, Git, Jenkins.

Project 6: Insurance Claims Portal (Insurance)

- **Situation:** Customers were struggling with a manual, paper-based claims process.
- **Task:** Build a self-service web application for claim submissions.
- **Action:** Developed the backend using Spring MVC and Hibernate within a Scrum team.
- **Result:** Reduced manual processing time by 50% within the first year.
- **Keywords:** Java 7, Spring MVC, Hibernate, Oracle DB, SOAP, Scrum.

Project 5: E-Commerce Engine (Retail)

- **Situation:** A retailer needed to handle high traffic spikes during "Sinterklaas" sales.
- **Task:** Optimize the checkout service and implement caching strategies.

- **Action:** Introduced Ehcache and refactored slow SQL queries while scaling JBoss clusters.
- **Result:** Achieved zero downtime during the peak holiday season.
- **Keywords:** Java 6, JBoss, Hibernate, Ehcache, MSSQL.

Employer: Ordina (1999 – 2010)

Project 4: HR Payroll System Upgrade (Public Sector)

- **Situation:** Transitioning from early Java versions to the Java EE 5 standard.
- **Task:** Migrate the business logic from EJBs to a modern JPA/JSF architecture.
- **Action:** Implemented the data layer using JPA (TopLink) and the frontend with JSF.
- **Result:** Modernized UI and significantly reduced maintenance overhead.
- **Keywords:** Java 5, JSF, JPA, GlassFish, SVN.

Project 3: First Java Web App (Finance)

- **Situation:** A bank wanted to move internal reporting from terminal-based to browser-based.
- **Task:** Build a web interface using early Java web technologies.
- **Action:** Developed Servlets and JSPs; used JDBC for direct database communication.
- **Result:** Provided 500+ employees with a user-friendly, centralized reporting tool.
- **Keywords:** J2SE 1.4, Servlets, JSP, JDBC, Tomcat 4.

Project 2: Y2K Aftermath & Maintenance (Telecommunications)

- **Situation:** Post-Y2K maintenance and patching for legacy systems.
- **Task:** Fix bugs and add features to a large COBOL/CICS codebase.
- **Action:** Maintained batch jobs and online transactions on the IBM Mainframe.
- **Result:** Ensured system stability during the transition to the Euro currency.
- **Keywords:** COBOL, CICS, JCL, DB2, IBM Mainframe.

Project 1: Junior COBOL Programmer (Banking)

- **Situation:** Large-scale Euro conversion project.
- **Task:** Adjust financial logic to handle the conversion from Guilders to Euros.
- **Action:** Rewrote calculation modules and performed extensive regression testing.
- **Result:** Successful, error-free Euro implementation for the mortgage department.
- **Keywords:** COBOL II, MVS, TSO/ISPF.

TECHNICAL SKILLS MATRIX

Category	Technologies
Languages	Java (1.4 through 17), COBOL, SQL, Bash
Frameworks	Spring Boot, Spring Cloud, Hibernate, Jakarta EE (EJB, JSF)
Cloud/DevOps	Azure (AKS, Functions), Docker, Kubernetes, Jenkins, Terraform
Data	PostgreSQL, Oracle, MongoDB, Redis, Kafka
Methodology	Scrum, Agile, CI/CD, TDD, Unit Testing

Hobbies

- Gaming
- Reading
- He also loves to go to Zuidlaren by boat.